

# Hao Zheng

Recent M.S. Graduate, Tsinghua University — Transportation Systems, Optimization, and Machine Learning

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## CORE METHOD AREAS

**Machine Learning:** Time Series Forecasting Graph Neural Networks Sequence-to-Sequence Models Transfer Learning

Knowledge-Guided Learning Multi-Task Learning Discrete Choice Modeling

**Optimization & Operations Research:** Mixed-Integer Programming Bilevel Optimization Column Generation

Branch-and-Price VRP/VRPTW ALNS Tabu Search

**Transportation & Infrastructure Modeling:** Space-Time Network Modeling Traffic Assignment Microscopic Traffic Simulation

Travel Demand Modeling Spatial Network Analysis Pavement Performance Prediction Pavement Maintenance Optimization

## EDUCATION

- **Tsinghua University | M.S. in Transportation Engineering** 09/2022 – 06/2025  
Department of Civil Engineering, Beijing, China GPA: **3.86/4.00**  
*Thesis: A Comprehensive Full-Process Planning Model for Pavement Performance Forecasting and Maintenance Strategy Implementation under Missing Data Conditions.*
- **Beijing Jiaotong University | B.Eng. in Traffic and Transportation** 09/2018 – 06/2022  
School of Traffic and Transportation, Beijing, China GPA: **3.80/4.00**; Weighted Average: **88.3/100**  
*Concentration: Railway Transportation.*  
*Thesis: Customized Bus Planning Method Responding to Spatiotemporal Concentrated Demand in Super-Peak.*

## CURRENT RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

- **Research Assistant**, Beijing Jiaotong University 07/2025 – Present  
*Modernization Laboratory for Intelligent Rail Transit Organization and Management*
- **Associate Member**, PIARC Technical Committee 1.1 (World Road Association) 2026 – Present

## PUBLICATIONS

- **Hao Zheng**, Han Zheng\*, George Giannopoulos. KNOWCAST: Domain-knowledge-integrated deep learning for metro OD forecasting and path flow estimation. DOI:10.1016/j.trc.2026.105710 🌐 *Transportation Research Part C: Emerging Technologies*, 189, 105710. 2026  
*Method focus:* Graph Neural Networks Sequence-to-Sequence Models Knowledge-Guided Learning
- **Hao Zheng**, Han Zheng\*, George Giannopoulos. Integrated Routing of Trucks and Robots for Multi-Modal Urban Express Logistics. 🌐 *Presented at the TRB 105th Annual Meeting, 2026; Transportation Research Record, Accepted for publication.* 2026  
*Method focus:* Space-Time Network Modeling Branch-and-Price Column Generation C#/Gurobi
- **Hao Zheng**, Jiantao Li, Yian Zhao, Xi Zhu, Runhua Guo\*. An operational scheduling framework for pavement maintenance activities: from rule-based task generation to branch-and-price-based route optimisation. DOI:10.1080/10298436.2026.2708283 🌐 *International Journal of Pavement Engineering, Article 2708283.* 2026  
*Method focus:* VRPTW Road Network Modeling Branch-and-Price Column Generation
- Jiantao Li, Yian Zhao, **Hao Zheng**, Runhua Guo. Vehicle Vibration Modelling via Road Profile Reconstruction and Simulation: Coupled Analysis of IRI, Speed, and Ride Comfort for Driving Assistance. DOI:10.1080/14680629.2025.2574300. *Road Materials and Pavement Design.* 2025  
*Method focus:* Road Profile Reconstruction Vehicle Dynamics Simulation IRI-Based Modeling
- Yuyan Tan, Yibo Li, Ruxin Wang, Xiwei Mi, Yaxuan Li, **Hao Zheng**, Yu Ke, Yan Wang. Improving Synchronization in High-Speed Railway and Air Intermodality: Integrated Train Timetable Rescheduling and Passenger Flow Forecasting. *IEEE Transactions on Intelligent Transportation Systems*, 23(3), 2651–2667. DOI:10.1109/TITS.2021.3137410. 2022  
*Method focus:* Timetable Rescheduling Passenger Flow Forecasting Multi-Objective Optimization
- **Hao Zheng**, Xingchen Zhang, Junhua Chen. Study on Customized Shuttle Transit Mode Responding to Spatiotemporal Inhomogeneous Demand in Super-Peak. *Information*, 12(10), 429. DOI:10.3390/info12100429 🌐 2021  
*Method focus:* Pickup-and-Delivery with Time Windows ALNS Tabu Search
- **Hao Zheng**, Yun Wang\*, Xuedong Yan, Yunwei Li. Dynamic Planning Model and Solution Algorithm for the Demand-responsive Customized Bus Route. *Proceedings of the World Transport Convention / World Transport Engineering and Technology Forum (WTC2021)*, People's Communications Press, 2021. ISBN: 9787114173554. 🌐 2021  
*Method focus:* Two-Stage Planning Dynamic Insertion Route Re-Optimization

## MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW AND IN PREPARATION

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- **Hao Zheng**, Runhua Guo\*, Xi Zhu, Jiantao Li, Long Wen, Weining Zhou. Public-Data-Assisted Staged Transfer Learning for Local Pavement Condition Prediction across Shared and Local Indicators.  Submitted to *International Journal of Pavement Engineering*. 2026  
Method focus: Transfer Learning Multi-Task Learning Sequence-to-Sequence Models
- **Hao Zheng**, Han Zheng\*, George Giannopoulos, et al. Heat-related road conditions and cycling network continuity across European cities. *Manuscript in preparation for submission to Nature Cities*. 2026  
Method focus: Spatial Network Analysis Network Robustness Accessibility Modeling Remote Sensing
- **Hao Zheng**, Han Zheng\*, George A. Giannopoulos, et al. DISCERN: Discrete Choice with Embedded Representation Networks. *Working paper*, 2026. 2026  
Method focus: Discrete Choice Models Representation Learning Gradient-Based Estimation

## SELECTED RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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- **Computational Benchmarking of Scalable Traffic Assignment on Open Transportation Networks** 2025 – Present  
*Research Collaborator with Prof. Xuesong Zhou*
  - Built an experimental pipeline converting TNTP-style benchmark networks into unified link-demand formats and generating path sets for path-based traffic assignment.
  - Evaluated path-compression strategies across compression ratios and demand levels, comparing solver time, objective gaps, and link-flow fit against baseline solutions.
- **Open Mobility Data Visibility: A Global Audit of Public Urban Mobility Data** 2026 – Present  
*Ongoing Research Project*
  - Developed a reproducible global audit covering 11,422 urban centres and integrating public transit directories, GTFS content, OpenStreetMap, GBFS, official/API entry points, and multilingual evidence.
  - Distinguished source discoverability, downloadable-data availability, parseability, spatially verifiable service visibility, and review-only evidence through versioned packages and city-level audit records.
- **Heat-related Road Conditions and Cycling Network Continuity across European Cities** 2026 – Present  
*Ongoing Research Project*
  - Built a 23-city comparative framework linking low-stress cycling networks with land-surface temperature, tree-cover deficit, built-up context, population, and destinations.
  - Evaluated connectivity, accessibility, route availability, and detour after treating the highest-scoring 5%, 10%, and 20% of roads as unavailable, with comparisons against random road sets matched by count or approximate total length.
- **Bilevel Optimization Framework for Tolling Strategy in Autonomous Networks**  06/2025 – 10/2025  
*MIT-UF-NEU Summer Research Camp | Program PI: Prof. Jinhua Zhao, MIT; Mentor: Dr. Xuan Jiang*
  - Designed an end-to-end bilevel optimization workflow for tolling strategy design, modeling interactions between infrastructure operators and autonomous vehicle fleets.
  - Implemented the Python-based upper-level optimization loop and re-engineered a C++/CUDA microscopic traffic simulator to support toll-responsive agent behavior.
- **Intelligent Road Asset Management: Prediction and Decision-Support Models** 2023 – 2025  
*Digital Transportation Management Platform | Supervisor: Prof. Runhua Guo*
  - Developed core prediction and maintenance decision modules for a digital road asset management platform, integrating pavement condition forecasting with maintenance strategy optimization.
  - Built GRU/attention-based pavement performance prediction models using climate, traffic, material, and LTPP data, and implemented budget- and performance-constrained maintenance decision models.
- **Customized Bus and Air–Rail Intermodal Optimization** 2020 – 2022  
*National University Student Innovation & Entrepreneurship Development Program | Project Leader*
  - Led the development of a two-stage optimization framework for air–rail passenger transfers, combining high-speed rail timetable adjustment with customized bus route planning.
  - Modeled the airport–station connection as a vehicle routing problem with time windows and transfers, and developed a hybrid ALNS–Tabu Search algorithm; the resulting software received a national software copyright.
- **Additional Applied Transportation and Infrastructure Research** 2022 – 2024
  - Contributed to research on green transportation and infrastructure lifecycle management, including intelligent inspection, pavement performance prediction, and maintenance decision-making models.
  - Conducted comparative analysis of highway design and acceptance standards for international transportation infrastructure adaptation.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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- **Programming & Modeling Languages:** Python, MATLAB, C#, C++.

- **Optimization Solvers & Modeling:** Gurobi, GAMS.
- **Optimization Methods:** mixed-integer programming, column generation, branch-and-price.
- **Machine Learning Frameworks:** TensorFlow, PyTorch.
- **Machine Learning Methods:** graph neural networks, sequence-to-sequence forecasting, transfer learning, multi-task learning.
- **Transportation & Infrastructure Modeling:** space-time network modeling, path-based traffic assignment, microscopic traffic simulation, travel demand modeling, spatial network analysis, pavement performance prediction, pavement maintenance optimization.
- **English:** TOEFL 112 (Reading 30, Listening 30, Speaking 25, Writing 27). 01/2025

## SELECTED HONORS

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| • Second-Class Academic Excellence Scholarship, Tsinghua University                                                    | 2024       |
| • Selected to Deliver the Incoming Master's Student Address at Tsinghua University's Graduate Student Opening Ceremony | 2022       |
| • Outstanding Graduate of Beijing Municipality (Top 5%, 19/380)                                                        | 2022       |
| • Wu Fu-Zhenhua Transportation Education Excellent Student Award (Top 0.1%, 1/1520)                                    | 2021       |
| • Zhan Tianyou Scholarship (Top 0.2%, 2/1520; Awarded Twice)                                                           | 2020, 2021 |
| • Zhixing Scholarship / President's Scholarship (Top 0.1%, 10/16800)                                                   | 2020       |